

CO2 AT2 – Function Calling

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Question 24: API-Based Structured Information Extraction Using Function Calling

Problem Statement

A company wants to use an LLM API to automatically extract customer information from emails. The extracted information should be returned in a structured JSON format so it can be directly stored in databases or CRM systems.

1. Aim

To design a **function-calling workflow** that extracts customer information from emails using an LLM API and returns a predictable JSON object through structured output.

Objectives

- Extract customer details automatically.
- Reduce manual effort.
- Generate structured JSON output.
- Enable database integration.
- Improve processing speed and accuracy.

2. Prompt

You are an intelligent information extraction assistant.

Read the customer email carefully and extract the following details:

- Customer Name
- Customer ID
- Email Address

- Phone Number
- Address
- Request Type

If any information is unavailable, return null.

Return the result only by calling the function

`extract_customer_information()`.

Do not generate normal text.

3. Function Calling Schema

Include:

- Function Name
- Purpose
- Parameters
- Required Fields
- Data Types
- JSON Function Schema

Function Name

`extract_customer_information()`

Purpose

Extracts customer details from an email and returns structured information.

Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
email_text	string	Yes	Customer email content
customer_name	string	Yes	Name of customer
customer_id	string	Yes	Customer identification number
email	string	Yes	Email address

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
phone	string	No	Phone number
address	string	No	Postal address
request_type	string	Yes	Type of customer request

JSON Function Schema

```
{
  "name": "extract_customer_information",
  "description": "Extract customer information from email",
  "parameters": {
    "type": "object",
    "properties": {
      "email_text": {
        "type": "string",
        "description": "Customer email content"
      },
      "customer_name": {
        "type": "string",
        "description": "Customer full name"
      },
      "customer_id": {
        "type": "string",
        "description": "Customer ID"
      },
      "email": {
        "type": "string",
        "description": "Customer email address"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
"phone": {
  "type": "string",
  "description": "Phone number"
},
"address": {
  "type": "string",
  "description": "Customer address"
},
"request_type": {
  "type": "string",
  "description": "Customer request type"
}
},
"required": [
  "email_text",
  "customer_name",
  "customer_id",
  "email",
  "request_type"
]
}
```

4. Structured Output Schema

Example Output

```
{
  "customer_name": "John Smith",
  "customer_id": "CUST-45231",
  "email": "john.smith@email.com",
```

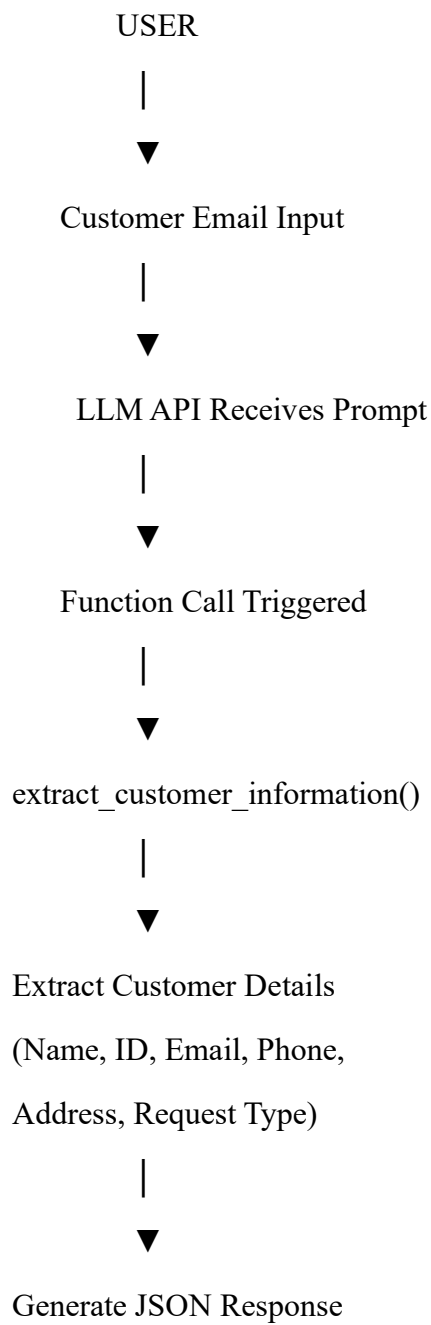
```
"phone": "+1-212-555-7890",  
"address": "45 Park Avenue, New York, NY 10016",  
"request_type": "Address Update"  
}
```

JSON Schema

```
{  
  "type": "object",  
  "properties": {  
    "customer_name": {  
      "type": "string"  
    },  
    "customer_id": {  
      "type": "string"  
    },  
    "email": {  
      "type": "string"  
    },  
    "phone": {  
      "type": "string"  
    },  
    "address": {  
      "type": "string"  
    },  
    "request_type": {  
      "type": "string"  
    }  
  },  
  "required": [  
    "customer_name",
```

```
"customer_id",  
"email",  
"request_type"  
]  
}
```

5. Function Calling Workflow



6. Python Implementation

```
File Edit Format Run Options Window Help
import re
import json

# -----
# Sample Customer Email
# -----
email_text = """
Subject: Address Update

Hello,

My name is John Smith.
Customer ID: CUST-45231

Please update my address to:
45 Park Avenue,
New York, NY 10016.

Phone: +1-212-555-7890
Email: john.smith@email.com

Thank you.
"""

# -----
# Function Calling Simulation
# -----
def extract_customer_information(email):

    # Customer Name
    name = None
    match = re.search(r"My name is ([A-Za-z ]+)", email)
    if match:
        name = match.group(1).strip()

    # Customer ID
    customer_id = None
    match = re.search(r"Customer ID:\s*([A-Za-z0-9\-\_]+)", email)
    if match:
        customer_id = match.group(1)

    # Email
    email_id = None
    match = re.search(r'[\w\.-]+@[\w\.-]+\.\w+', email)
    if match:
        email_id = match.group()
```

Output :

```
IDLE Shell 3.14.3
File Edit Shell Debug Options Window Help
Enter "help" below or click "Help" above for more information.
>>> ===== RESTART: C:/Users/panee/OneDrive/Documents/gvfg.py =====
API-Based Structured Information Extraction
=====
Structured JSON Output:
{
  "customer_name": "John Smith",
  "customer_id": "CUST-45231",
  "email": "john.smith@email.com",
  "phone": "+1-212-555-7890",
  "address": "45 Park Avenue, New York, NY 10016.",
  "request_type": "Address Update"
}
Program Executed Successfully.
>>> ===== RESTART: C:/Users/panee/OneDrive/Documents/gvfg.py =====
API-Based Structured Information Extraction
=====
Structured JSON Output:
{
  "customer_name": "John Smith",
  "customer_id": "CUST-45231",
  "email": "john.smith@email.com",
  "phone": "+1-212-555-7890",
  "address": "45 Park Avenue, New York, NY 10016.",
  "request_type": "Address Update"
}
Program Executed Successfully.
>>> |
Ln: 39 Col: 0
```

7. Test Cases

Test Case 1

Email

My name is Alice Brown.

Customer ID: CUST-1001

Email: alice@gmail.com

Phone: 9876543210

Please update my address.

Output

```
{  
  "customer_name": "Alice Brown",  
  "customer_id": "CUST-1001",  
  "email": "alice@gmail.com",  
  "phone": "9876543210",  
  "address": null,  
  "request_type": "Address Update"  
}
```

Test Case 2

Email

Customer ID: CUST-5678

My internet is not working.

Output

```
{  
  "customer_name": null,  
  "customer_id": "CUST-5678",
```



```
"email":null,  
"phone":null,  
"address":null,  
"request_type":"Technical Support"  
}
```

Test Case 3

Email

My name is Sarah.

Customer ID: CUST-9988

I want a refund.

Email: sarah@email.com

Output

```
{  
  "customer_name":"Sarah",  
  "customer_id":"CUST-9988",  
  "email":"sarah@email.com",  
  "phone":null,  
  "address":null,  
  "request_type":"Refund"  
}
```

Test Case 4

Email

John Smith

Customer ID: CUST-9000

Phone: 9876543210

My package arrived damaged.

Output

```
{  
  "customer_name":"John Smith",  
  "customer_id":"CUST-9000",  
  "email":null,  
  "phone":"9876543210",  
  "address":null,  
  "request_type":"Complaint"  
}
```

Test Case 5

Email

Please close my account.

Customer ID: CUST-1111

Email: user@test.com

Output

```
{  
  "customer_name":null,  
  "customer_id":"CUST-1111",  
  "email":"user@test.com",  
  "phone":null,  
  "address":null,  
  "request_type":"Account Closure"  
}
```

8. Edge Cases

Missing Email

Input

email_text=""

Output

```
{  
  "error": "Email content is missing."  
}
```

Invalid Data Type

Input

email_text=12345

Output

```
{  
  "error": "Email content must be a string."  
}
```

No Customer Information Found

Input

Hello

Thank you.

Output

```
{  
  "error": "No customer information found."  
}
```

9. Design Justification

- **Function Calling:** Separates the extraction logic from text generation, making the workflow modular and reusable.
- **Structured Output:** Ensures every API response follows the same JSON format, enabling direct integration with CRM systems and databases.
- **Validation:** Required parameters and data type checks prevent invalid or incomplete function calls.

- **Consistency:** A fixed schema guarantees predictable outputs across different customer emails.
- **Edge-Case Handling:** Handles missing fields, invalid input types, and incomplete emails gracefully without producing malformed JSON.

10. Result

The designed function-calling workflow successfully extracts customer information from unstructured emails and converts it into a **predictable JSON object**. Compared to free-text responses, structured output improves **accuracy, consistency, reliability, and ease of integration** with downstream applications such as CRM systems, customer support platforms, and databases. This makes the solution suitable for automating customer information extraction at scale.